



PP1 - Welcome to Week 3! 🎉 (a few things before Monday)

From Jack Stirling <jack.stirling@rmit.edu.au>

Date Fri 7/31/2026 9:15 AM

To Devaroshan Alphonse <S4226190@student.rmit.edu.au>; Sophie Askill <S4261788@student.rmit.edu.au>; Callan Beaton <S3903669@student.rmit.edu.au>; Pierre Coutant <S3949969@student.rmit.edu.au>; Natercia De Assis Jorge <S3934900@student.rmit.edu.au>; Nicole Ruth Fernandez <S3888918@student.rmit.edu.au>; Isabelle Hinton-Russell <S4262937@student.rmit.edu.au>; Yu-Chun Ho <S4174249@student.rmit.edu.au>; Daryl Naveena Jebaraj <S4182288@student.rmit.edu.au>; Himanshu Lad <S4149581@student.rmit.edu.au>; Kankawee Maksomboon <S4097770@student.rmit.edu.au>; Joe David Edro Manurung <S4222749@student.rmit.edu.au>; Patrick Overton <S3946301@student.rmit.edu.au>; Zeeko Papanicolaou <S3945186@student.rmit.edu.au>; Prani Patton <s3719565@student.rmit.edu.au>; Thai Chuong Pham <s3198310@student.rmit.edu.au>; Renita Sasias <S4228217@student.rmit.edu.au>; Jidapa Yuvaboon <S4234949@student.rmit.edu.au>

Howdy everyone,

Hope you've had a great couple of weeks! Week 1 and 2 have flown by, and I've genuinely enjoyed the discussions and lectures so far – meeting you all and hearing about the diverse experiences you're bringing to this subject has been a highlight. I'm really looking forward to seeing that diversity come through in your work.

A few things before we dive into Week 3:

1. Monday morning lecture

Make sure you're there, listening, and taking notes. I want everyone to walk away with 2 things that resonated or intrigued you from the lecture – write them down. We'll be drawing on these in class, so come with something you want to say. No hiding this week!

2. Welcome to Week 3

I'm really looking forward to seeing your first diagram drafts – they should already be showing some compositional ideas and thematic linking from the readings, lectures, and discussions so far. Here's a quick recap of what we've covered in Weeks 1 and 2, in case there are any gaps in your notes:

Week 1 – Deontology vs Professional Ethics

- Professional ethics is about the good – what good a profession is trying to serve. Deontology is about duty and obligation – the norms every professional must observe.
- Ethics is ultimately a matter of individual conscience; deontology sits in the realm of what's approved by professional authorities.
- Key idea: technically competent, ethically responsible – always acting for the benefit of the client, the community, and the environment, with autonomy.
- From Beaton's **Why Professionalism is Still Relevant** – a profession confers status, organises itself into a body, is learned, altruistic, autonomous, ethically informed, non-commercial, collectively influential, self-regulatory, collegial, and client-focused.
- And a line worth sitting with: when a profession's viewpoint outweighs the public interest, it risks losing its power, prestige, and profits if that outlook isn't corrected. Professions and society exist in a

symbiotic relationship – one that thrives when the profession leads with ethics, serving the public good above its own interests.

Week 2 – Conceptual Frameworks: Organising Complex Systems

- Think back to the precedent images from the brief – flywheel diagrams, ecosystems, layered systems, networks, cycles, hierarchies.
- What organising principle does each one use, and why did the author choose it?
- These are frameworks to think **with**, not templates to copy. A diagram of the profession should reveal an argument, not just list components.
- The registration pathway (education → employment → registration) should act as the spine of your matrix – everything else attaches to it.
- Remember the Professional Practice Resource Map categories from the brief: registration, professional institutes, legislation, codes & ethics, procurement, practice & industry, research, public interest.

3. Uniqueness is greatness

Put your own spin on your diagrams. I want to see the themes, linkages, and ideas out there in **your** way. I can't emphasise enough what an opportunity this is to represent yourself, your thinking, and your style in a piece of work. Avoid banality. Seek out frivolity. Ground it in a strong, personified position, and present it through great diagram design.

4. One last thing to chew on

All great examples of good design – architectural drawings, plans, sections, axons, diagrams, even fine art like painting and sculpture – can be read at three different distances, with layers revealing themselves as the viewer moves closer. That's a big clue. There should be one reading from afar that gives an overall impression, another at medium distance, and a final layer of detail up close.

Read that last bit again. Then go have a think about it over the next few days.

5. A few precedents to look at

If you want some inspiration for what a really well-organised, thematically layered diagram can look like, check these out:

- **MVRDV's project diagrams** (e.g. Silodam, Mirador, and their "Architecture Speaks" series) – colourful, sequential diagrams that distill an entire design argument into a clear visual story. Search "How Architecture Is Born: MVRDV diagrams" on Architizer for a good rundown.
- **OMA / Rem Koolhaas diagrams** – often built around one strong organising system (a section, a stack, a circulation spine) with layers of complexity nested inside it. Great precedent for the "spine with everything attaching to it" idea.
- **Otto Neurath's Isotype system** (Vienna, 1920s–30s) – not architecture, but the best example out there of a diagram that works at multiple reading distances: instantly legible from afar, and rewarding closer inspection with more precise detail. Well worth a look for how to build layered readability without visual clutter.

Have a look, have a think, and bring some of that thinking into your drafts.
Looking forward to seeing you all Monday!

Cheers,
Jack